2.19 Altered Bowel Elimination: Constipation and Diarrhea*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I have not opened my bowels for 4 days." **Objective** • Hard, dry stool • Abdominal distension	**ACTUAL** Impaired intestinal elimination related to reduced activity and fluid intake as evidenced by no stool for 4 days and hard stool.	• Soft stool passed within 48 hours.	• Encourage fluid and fiber. • Get her moving. • Give the prescribed laxative. • Allow privacy and a regular time for toileting.	• Achieved once a soft stool is passed.
Subjective • "I have frequent watery stools." **Objective** • Six liquid stools a day • Hyperactive bowel sounds	**ACTUAL** Impaired gastrointestinal motility related to infection or medication as evidenced by frequent liquid stools.	• Fewer, formed stools within 72 hours.	• Record frequency and character of stools. • Send a specimen if ordered. • Keep her hydrated. • Protect the perianal skin.	• Outcome reached when stools are formed.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Ongoing diarrhea	**RISK** Risk for inadequate fluid volume as evidenced by risk factors: excessive gastrointestinal fluid loss.	• Fluid balance maintained.	• Track intake, output and weight. • Encourage oral rehydration. • Give IV fluids as ordered.	• Considered met when intake and output are balanced.

* **References for this care plan:** [17], [35], [48], [110]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.